

Request for Information (RFI) - Drug Enforcement Administration (DEA)

This Request for Information (RFI) is issued by the DEA for market research and planning purposes only in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) Part 10. This RFI shall not be construed as a solicitation or as an obligation on the part of the Government. The Government is not requesting nor accepting proposals, bids, or formal quotes at this time, and responses to this RFI will not be used for source selection purposes. The purpose of this RFI is to gain a better understanding of industry capabilities, available solutions, and general cost considerations related to the requirements described herein. Information received may be used to improve the Government's acquisition strategy and planning.

The Government anticipated North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) code 513210- Software Publishers may be applicable to this requirement. This is provided for market research purposes only and is not binding for any future acquisition.

Respondents are advised that the Government will not pay for any information or administrative costs incurred in response to this RFI. All submissions become Government property and will not be returned.

Introduction and Purpose– AI-driven Supply Chain Analytics Platform

The Drug Enforcement Administration (DEA) is seeking information from industry on AI-powered supply chain analytical tools. This RFI is issued solely for market research and planning purposes. The DEA's goal is to use AI-powered supply chain analytical tools to enable and support investigations into the supply chains for precursor and essential chemicals used in synthetic drug production. DEA needs enhanced ability to conduct in-depth investigations into the supply chains of input chemicals for fentanyl and methamphetamine. DEA also needs to understand the company networks around these supply chains. DEA needs to perform rapid analysis and risk assessment of entities involved in the production, distribution, and purchase of these chemicals, enabling DEA to identify high-risk actors and to track the flow of precursor chemicals critical to illicit drug production. Interested parties are asked to provide information on technical capabilities, innovative features, and approaches to meeting the requirements described below, in a vendor-agnostic manner that leverages current and emerging technologies.

General Capabilities

Respondents should detail how their solution provides the following core capabilities. There is interest in both currently available features and forward-looking enhancements that reflect cutting-edge developments in law enforcement technology. The DEA requires a software platform that can deliver supply chain visibility and analytical capabilities:

- Verify leads using a protected AI large language model that traverses facility-level shipment data to identify which items and capital equipment can be used for fentanyl and other synthetic drug production. This capability also integrates data on all key precursor chemicals as well as contextual data on companies involved in the transaction of these.
- Leverage technology to improve the efficiency and efficacy of counternarcotics investigations.
- Provide additional threat assessment capability with a dynamic, intelligent map of the global supply chain that leverages the trade activity of hundreds of millions of companies to identify companies most likely to be involved in illegal narcotics activity.
- Leverage automated, supervised models that are trained on known and highly suspicious companies and entities. These models shall use the characteristics of the companies, their products, and extended relationships to recognize behaviors of interest, resulting in new leads for investigation.
- Provide a platform backed by a unique data algorithm that ingests data across both non-public industry data and commercially available data, covering roughly 600 million companies and their ownership structures and billions of global shipments, including unique places of interest coverage not available through commercial tools reliant exclusively on public data or commercial data or proprietary aggregations of such data.
- The platform shall provide the best coverage of facility-to-facility transactions globally.
- The platform shall enable public private collaboration. The platform shall be backed by a federated architecture that allows the platform to learn from information provided by importers on goods being shipped into the US without exposing sensitive business data, improving connectivity and model outputs.
- The platform should be highly adaptable and configurable to meet DEA's nascent requirements as needs and organizational and enforcement priorities change. Additional configurations beyond core platform capabilities shall be mutually agreed upon by the vendor and the Government.
- The platform shall have a FedRAMP-High Authorization. A FedRAMP-High authorization demonstrates significant commitment to cybersecurity best practices and authorizes the platform for use in federal networks at the High impact level, enabling DEA to deploy the platform with the assurance that it meets the stringent security and risk management requirements necessary to handle the DEA's most sensitive, unclassified data.

- The platform must enable a variety of robust partner data integrations if needed. The platform shall be backed by robust entity resolution algorithms that can ingest, clean, and resolve partner data from a variety of sources to enhance the connectivity and actionable insight created in the platform.

The solution shall provide the following outcomes:

- a. DEA expects to generate information regarding relationships, attributes, behaviors or transactions that did not transpire in the real world or analyze content that did not transpire in the real world (in each case, as set forth in the underlying data sources and records). Insights, risk signals, and connections directly traceable back to the underlying data sources and records. Thereby bolstering intelligence to assist agents targeting national and transnational drug trafficking organizations.
- b. DEA expects to have operational level visibility into shipments, facilities, and corporate networks to quickly and efficiently uncover hidden trade patterns, expose illicit networks, rapidly collaborate, and share information with partner agencies, allies, and industry. The platform should help DEA to detect and disrupt illicit drug networks, enforce narcotics-related laws, and safeguard national and global security by collaborating with the private sector and other government entities.
- c. The platform shall transform fragmented trade data into actionable network intelligence, enabling organizations to shift from reactive compliance to proactive risk management. The platform enhances national security, strengthens trade enforcement, improves supply chain resilience, and mitigates financial and reputational risk.

The solution shall solve the following problem:

- d. DEA needs to leverage an integrated environment for exploring global trade and supply chain data — combining economic, financial, and trade information with exclusive private sector data — to trace product value chains and understand how risk propagates across them. Specifically, DEA needs better insight into the supply chains of input chemicals for fentanyl and methamphetamine and to understand the company networks around specific transactions.

The solution shall address the following capability gaps:

- **Fragmented Data Silos** -Trade data, corporate registries, shipping manifests, and sanctions lists exist in isolated systems. Organizations cannot effectively correlate these datasets into a cohesive intelligence picture.

- **Limited Multi-Tier Visibility** - Most entities only monitor direct suppliers or customers, leaving sub-tier supply chain participants unexamined and unverified.
- **Reactive Compliance Posture** - Compliance efforts are often reactive, triggered only after enforcement actions, penalties, or supply disruptions occur.
- **Static Screening Limitations** - Traditional screening relies on static name-based checks against sanctions lists and watchlists, failing to detect indirect exposure through ownership networks or routing patterns.

Categorized Capabilities

1. Data Coverage

- **Global Corporate Coverage:**
 - The platform shall provide detailed corporate intelligence covering ownership structures, financial data, and risk/compliance information on over 500 million entities worldwide.
 - Corporate data shall be sourced from hundreds of official sources globally, including company registries, stock exchanges, and regulatory bodies.
 - Data should be standardized to enable seamless cross-border analysis and comparison, incorporating local language information.
 - Corporate data shall be updated continuously, with key changes to financials and ownership structures processed at least weekly.
- **International Trade Data**
 - The platform should integrate commercially acquired customs declaration and bill of lading data covering transactions touching almost every country in the world.
 - Trade data shall provide granular, shipment-level records of goods flowing through the global supply chain, covering more than 3.5 billion supply chain links.
 - Trade records should be updated regularly (as frequently as weekly).
- **Proprietary / Non-Public Logistics Data**
 - The platform should incorporate non-public, first-party data from partnerships with global logistics providers.
 - This data should provide visibility into previously opaque trade flows.
- **Data Quality Assurance**
 - All incoming data feeds should undergo automated validation testing evaluating consistency, reliability, and integrity before acceptance.

- Data from each information provider shall be standardized into a consistent format, including mapping of identifiers, company names, financials, addresses, and legal forms.
- Issues detected during validation shall be categorized and resolved, with collaboration with information providers to address discrepancies.
- For complex data types (e.g., patents), fuzzy logic algorithms shall be used for matching, with manual review for matches below a confidence threshold.
- A dedicated team shall manage weekly release cycles with regression testing

2. Visualization & Network Analysis Capabilities

- The platform shall display connections between companies, people, ownership structures, and risk factors as interactive graphical networks (nodes and edges).
- Users shall be able to click to expand nodes, revealing deeper multi-tier connections.
- Users shall be able to apply filters to focus on specific criteria (location, transaction dates, risk types).
- The platform shall provide clear hierarchical views of corporate ownership structures.
- Analysts shall be able to trace ownership up to the ultimate beneficial owner through complex, multi-level, and transnational structures.
- All visual data shall be supported by detailed tabular lists that can be sorted, filtered, and exported.
- All entities with location data shall be visualizable on a world map.
- The platform shall allow identification of concentrations of risk, unusual shipping routes, and entities operating in close proximity.
- The platform shall provide clear hierarchical views of corporate ownership structures.
- Analysts shall be able to trace ownership up to the ultimate beneficial owner through complex, multi-level, and transnational structures.
- All visual data shall be supported by detailed tabular lists that can be sorted, filtered, and exported.
- The platform shall automatically screen entities and their networks against integrated risk datasets.
- Entities appearing on sanctions lists, identified as politically exposed persons (PEPs), or linked to adverse media shall be visually flagged within the network graph.

3. Search Functionality Capabilities

- Users shall be able to initiate searches using company names, business registration numbers, customs processes, shipping information (IMO Number, Container Number, Bill of Lading, Tax ID), physical addresses, and goods descriptions (HS codes, ECCNs, part numbers, model/make/serial numbers).
- Search algorithms shall account for spelling variations, translations, and different naming conventions.
- The platform shall enable users to search by specific address or geofenced area to identify all registered entities and trading activity associated with that location.
- Users shall be able to draw custom polygons on a map to define areas of interest.
- The platform shall resolve addresses as distinct entities to disambiguate physical addresses from the companies operating there.
- The platform shall support transaction-level searches across fields such as ECCN, HS code, transaction dates, port information, and sender/receiver information.

4. Sanctions List Coverage Capabilities

- The platform shall integrate and cross-reference restricted entity and activity lists from a minimum of 140 nations and international bodies.
- New or updated sanctions lists shall be cleaned and resolved into the knowledge graph within 24 hours of release.
- Coverage shall include financial sanctions, broad sanctions, export controls, terrorism, forced labor, and criminal indictments/wanted persons.
- When a company is identified with a direct risk exposure, the platform shall automatically analyze its corporate network to identify indirect risk.
- The platform shall apply specific propagation rules ("motifs") based on the legal scope and interpretation of each regulation.
- The platform shall support the configuration development and deployment of custom, model-based risk assessments for threats not yet covered by official sanctions.
- Custom lists shall be able to propagate through ownership networks based on configurable criteria.

5. Ownership & Corporate Structure Analysis Capabilities

- The platform shall record explicit direct ownership links and compute indirect and total ownership by tracing connections through every layer of a corporate structure.
- The platform shall construct full ownership hierarchies (ownership trees), including cross-border relationships.
- The platform shall identify Ultimate Beneficial Owners (UBOs) and Global Ultimate Owners (GUOs) regardless of jurisdiction.
- The platform shall classify entities by type and flag entities classified as "Public authority, State, Government."
- If an entity's GUO is classified as a state entity, the subject company shall also be flagged as state-owned.
- The platform shall track both direct and indirect state ownership through multiple corporate layers, typically applying a threshold of 50% or more to define control.
- The platform shall incorporate a framework for assessing SOE risk profiles combining corporate credit risk with sovereign credit analysis.
- The assessment shall evaluate, standalone profile (financial health, operational performance, governance) and sovereign support (likelihood of government intervention).
- The framework shall analyze six factors: ownership level, economic importance, political linkages, government intervention history, guarantees, and barriers to support.
- The platform shall use AI-powered entity resolution to untangle cross-border ownership chains and identify UBOs.
- The platform shall integrate data from official registries, regulatory disclosures, and corporate filings.
- The platform shall incorporate non-public global trade data to reveal inferred relationships and de facto control structures.
- The platform shall provide visibility into ownership through nominee structures, controlling parties, and license holders in regulated sectors.

6. Criminal Network & Terrorism Screening Capabilities

- The platform shall ingest and resolve information from international bodies (Interpol, Europol) containing criminal indictments and wanted persons.
- The platform shall identify both direct and indirect links to criminal entities through complex ownership structures, shared directorships, or geographical proximity.

- The platform shall integrate terrorism-related lists and watchlists from a minimum of 140 nations.
- The platform shall use advanced name-matching and relationship mapping to uncover links to terrorist actors, including through aliases and intermediaries.
- The platform shall map designated organizations and associated individuals, locations, and community linkages.
- The platform shall assign specific risk classifications for terrorism-related activities, distinguishable from other risk categories.

7. Entity Resolution & Data Confidence Capabilities

- The platform shall employ an advanced entity resolution engine that fuses billions of records from disparate sources into distinct, canonical profiles.
- The engine shall use a supervised machine learning model producing probabilistic match scores.
- The platform shall clearly distinguish between verified/declared data and derived/predicted insights

8. Source Transparency & References Capabilities

- For corporate entity data, the primary source shall be clearly identified.
- Each trade transaction record shall include references to its source (customs declaration, bill of lading, or logistics partner data) with origin and date/time stamps.
- Where multiple records are fused, the system shall retain metadata from all contributing original sources.
- Data generated by models shall be clearly distinguished from source-declared data in separate, labelled fields.
- Reference URLs shall be provided for risk lists.

9. Collaboration & Case Management Capabilities

- Analysts shall be able to save investigative work as "explorations" and share live, dynamic versions with colleagues.
- The platform shall provide a "Case ID" feature with a universal identifier persisting from initial search through to final export.
- The platform shall enable direct commenting and annotations on entities.
- The platform shall support assignment of tasks and entities to specific users or teams.

10. Financial Intelligence Capabilities

- The platform shall provide granular insight into direct, indirect, and ultimate beneficial ownership for corporate structures covering a minimum of 580 million entities.

Responses should address the need to leverage an integrated environment for exploring global trade and supply chain data — combining economic, financial, and trade information with exclusive private sector data — to trace supply chains of interest and to understand how risk propagates across them.

This software is a new requirement DEA does not possess software that encompasses open source maritime, shipping, and private industry data.

Functional Requirements

1. Core services/ specifications required
 - AI-Driven Entity Resolution: Ability to accurately link corporate entities, vessels, shipments, ownership structures, and trade records across fragmented global datasets.
 - Multi-Tier Supply Chain Mapping: Capability to identify and visualize upstream and downstream relationships across multiple tiers of suppliers and intermediaries.
 - Integrated Data Environment: Aggregation of trade data, corporate registries, sanctions lists, export control lists, and logistics information into a unified intelligence framework.
 - Network-Based Risk Scoring: Advanced analytics to identify indirect exposure to sanctioned entities, forced labor risks, export control violations, and trade-based money laundering indicators.
2. Major tasks or capability areas
 - Risk Detection and Monitoring: Continuous monitoring of supply chain participants and transaction flows to proactively identify anomalies and emerging risks.
 - Compliance Support: Enable proactive compliance screening aligned with sanctions regulations, forced labor prevention laws, and export control requirements.
 - Investigative Support: Provide network visualization and analytical tools to support enforcement actions, trade investigations, and financial crime detection.
 - Public-Private Information Sharing: Facilitate structured collaboration between government agencies and private sector entities while maintaining appropriate data governance safeguards.
3. Performance expectations

- Accuracy: High-confidence entity matching and minimal false-positive screening results.
- Timeliness: Near real-time data updates and rapid risk flagging capabilities.
- Scalability: Ability to operate across global trade volumes and complex multinational supply networks.
- Security and Compliance: Adherence to federal cybersecurity standards and applicable data protection requirements.

Uptime:

- The platform shall be available 24/7 with a minimum uptime target of 99.5%.
- The vendor shall offer a standardized SLA with a minimum availability guarantee of 98%.

User Support:

- Support should be available via both email and telephone.
- Primary helpdesk support shall be available during core working hours (0900–1700 EST, Monday to Friday).
- User support shall be included within the annual license fee.
- Training & Documentation:
 - The vendor shall offer training during the implementation phase including start-up meetings and/or workshops.
 - Training shall be delivered in English in various formats: in-person workshops, live online sessions, video tutorials.
 - A minimum of eight formal training sessions per year shall be offered.
 - The vendor shall offer regular office hours / drop-in sessions hosted for ongoing support.
 - A dedicated online help center shall provide product documentation, video tutorials, and user guides.
 - A bespoke support portal shall host Government-specific training materials, data documentation, and release notes.
 - Training content shall be tailored to the Government's mission-specific use cases.
 - Training shall cater to all expertise levels (policy/licensing officers through data scientists).
 - All training and documentation shall be included within the fixed license price.

4. Key deliverables (if known)

Uses of continuous platform to aid in and enhance investigations.

- AI-driven entity resolution linking companies, vessels, shipments, and ownership structures.
- Multi-tier supply chain mapping across upstream and downstream networks.
- Network-based risk scoring and anomaly detection.
- Proactive identification of sanctions exposure forced labor risks, and export control violations.

- Enhanced coordination between public and private sector stakeholders through shared intelligence frameworks.

Technical / Capability Requirements

Standalone & Browser-Based:

- The platform shall function as a standalone system requiring no integration with the Government's internal systems.
- The platform shall be accessible via a standard web browser without local installation.
- All communication shall be protected using industry-standard encryption protocols.
- Network & Access Controls:
 - Internet-facing components shall be protected by a network firewall and IP allow lists.
 - User access shall be manageable through SSO (integrated with the Government's identity provider) or email/password.
 - The platform shall support Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) enforcing the principle of least privilege.
- Data Sovereignty & Privacy:
 - The platform shall use a federated, hub-and-spoke architecture guaranteeing the Government's data remains sovereign.
 - The Government's data shall reside in a logically separate and secure enclave.
 - No data belonging to the Government shall be used to map, train, or communicate the Government's interests to central models.
- The platform shall employ federated learning models that learn from patterns without accessing underlying proprietary partner data.
- Data Residency:
 - The platform shall be deployable on hyperscale public cloud providers (AWS, Azure) in specific geographic regions.
- Certifications
 - The vendor shall hold ISO 27001, SOC 2 Type I & II, and Cyber Essentials Plus certifications.
- Authorizations
 - The platform shall have a FedRAMP-High Authorization.
 - The following Security requirements are applicable:
 - Personnel must have a Top Secret (TS) security clearance to handle DEA target information and data. Other all data will be identified as law enforcement sensitive and may not be shared with public entities.

Training & Documentation

- The vendor shall offer training during the implementation phase including start-up meetings and/or workshops.

- Training shall be delivered in English in various formats: in-person workshops, live online sessions, video tutorials.
- A minimum of eight formal training sessions per year shall be offered. The vendor shall offer regular office hours / drop-in sessions hosted for ongoing support.
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Period of Performance

12-month base period with two (2), 12-month option periods

Contract Type

Firm Fixed Price FFP

Questions for Industry

The DEA invites vendors and integrators to respond to the following questions. Please provide detailed answers, with examples or case studies as applicable, to help us understand the art-of-the-possible and market maturity for the requested capabilities: you need to ask the questions to clear up information DEA doesn't have about what industries can provide.

1. Is there a solution that fulfills the capabilities outlined herein?
2. Can your solution address 85% of the capabilities outlined above? Explain.
3. Is there a better solution available?
4. Generative AI and Analytics: In what ways does your solution leverage AI or machine learning to enhance analysis?
5. Security and Compliance: Describe the security architecture of your solution. How do you meet FedRAMP High requirements, and what encryption and access control measures are in place? Is your solution currently authorized at FedRAMP High or another comparable standard (if not, what is your plan to achieve it)? Explain.
6. Future Roadmap and Innovation: Given the DEA's interest in a forward-looking platform, what is your vision for the next 3-5 years in this domain? How do you plan to incorporate emerging technologies such as more advanced AI.
7. Deployment and Pricing Model: (For informational purposes) Describe at a high level how your solution is deployed and licensed. Is it offered as a subscription service, or

as a software license installed in the DEA's cloud environment? What components (hardware, if any, or cloud resources) would DEA need to provision? While pricing specifics are not required at this stage, understanding the commercial model (e.g., user-based licensing, data volume-based pricing, enterprise license, etc.) will help in planning future acquisition strategies.

8. What security clearance does your company maintain if any?
9. What vetting process does your company utilized to select employees?
10. Rough Order of Magnitude (ROM): To assist the Government in acquisition planning and budgeting, respondents are requested to provide a non-binding Rough Order of Magnitude (ROM) estimate for providing the capabilities described in this RFI for a one-year period of performance. The ROM should be based on the assumptions, scope, and the environment described herein. Respondents may state any additional assumptions used in developing their estimate. The ROM should be expressed as a total estimated annual cost and may be presented as a range. The Government understands that this estimate is preliminary, for planning purposes only, and does not represent a commitment by either party. Respondents are encouraged to provide any relevant pricing factors, licensing models, or cost considerations that would help the Government understand how pricing for this type of solution is typically structured in the commercial marketplace. Respondents are encouraged to describe their typical pricing structure (e.g., subscription, user-based, data-based, enterprise licensing, implementation costs, and sustainment costs) and identify any factors that most significantly influence overall cost. The Government is only interested in ROM for perpetual licensing currently.

Submission Instructions

Responses to this RFI should be provided in writing and include the following where possible: company information, CAGE code, point of contact, a brief overview of relevant experience, answers to the questions above, and any product literature or white papers that elaborate on your solution's capabilities.

- Response Format: Please organize responses following the structure of the Questions for Industry section, plus any introductory material. Responses should be keep to a maximum of 10 pages at no smaller than 12-point font. Marketing brochures alone are sufficient. You may also include relevant use-cases or screenshots (appropriately marked as sensitive if needed) to illustrate capabilities.
- Submission Deadline: **Responses are due by April 27, 2026 at 2:00PM Eastern.** Please submit via email to fac.proposal.submission@dea.gov with the subject line: **RFI Response:15DDHQ-26-RFI-FAIT03- AI-driven Supply Chain Analytics Platform.**
- Confidentiality: Mark any proprietary information as such. The DEA will handle response information as sensitive and not share it outside of government evaluators, but it will not sign NDAs for RFI responses. Do not include any classified information in your response.

- Questions: Interested parties may submit clarification questions regarding this RFI to fac.proposal.submission@dea.gov **April 15, 2026, at 3:00PM Eastern**. The Government may choose to publish Q&A responses openly if deemed beneficial to all respondents (with any vendor-specific information removed).